Secondary Persona: Connected Caleb



Description / Bio:
Caleb is 22 and a second-year BSc student in Computer Science and Data Science, aiming to become a developer of cybersecurity technology. His group projects (about 6 people) are usually assigned randomly in labs, so he often starts work with strangers. He is comfortable with Git and Discord and uses AI models for quick technical questions, but his groups use whatever each person prefers (Messenger, text, email, Discord, GitLab, Google Drive, Outlook), and only GitLab and Outlook come from university. He is happy to use whichever tools people prefer, but nothing connects them, so information gets lost. Caleb is a secondary persona: he represents a low-structure group, in contrast to Cara's primary persona, whose group is organised through Discord and weekly meetings but is let down when a member disappears. He tests whether the design still works when a group has no shared habits to build on.

Quote:
"Things got lost in translation, work got done twice."

Goals:

End goals

- **K1.** See at a glance who is doing what and what is finished
- **K2.** Keep communication and files in one place so work isn't duplicated or l
- **K3.** Be confident the complete project is submitted with nothing missing
- **K4.** Be able to start working with the group quickly, knowing who they are
- **K5.** Get help on a group problem without losing context about what the group has done

Experience goals

- Feel "in the loop" and confident nothing is slipping, rather than finding out at the last minute
- Feel the effort of coordinating is worthwhile

Life goal

- Become a capable developer of cybersecurity technology who works well in professional teams

Needs:

- **Task board with owner and status (K1),** synced from existing tools (e.g. a closed GitLab issue marks the task done). This replaces his shared doc that went stale, and follows visibility of system status (Nielsen, 1994).
- **One hub that links to, not replaces, the group's tools (K2),** with a "Project resources" panel pinning the repo, Drive and Discord, each showing last-updated time. This addresses duplicated and lost work and follows consistency and standards and recognition rather than

recall (Nielsen, 1994). Linking instead of replacing also fits survey feedback that hiding Git could stop students learning it.

- **Shared activity feed (K1, K2)** of recent updates, so everyone sees the same information, which follows visibility of system status (Nielsen, 1994).
- **"Ready to submit?" checklist (K3)** listing required deliverables, their owners and status. This removes the "we didn't know what was missing until it was sent" problem and follows error prevention (Nielsen, 1994).
- **Automatic group page per course (K4),** appearing on the dashboard when groups are assigned, with names and contact details. This addresses the lack of an ECS equivalent to the university group page and follows consistency and standards (Nielsen, 1994).
- **"Ask for help" with group status attached (K5),** so tutors see the context without the student re-explaining, which follows help and documentation (Nielsen, 1994).

Pain Points:

- Shared task doc was never updated and became outdated (from interview)
- Everyone edited a downloaded copy of the same file and the same work got done twice (from interview)
- Files had to be gathered from several places and sent to one person, with no idea what was missing until then (from interview)
- No central communication, so some members knew more than others (from interview)
- Progress was hard to see outside labs; people only shared in person (from interview)
- Didn't know the universities group page existed until recently, and nothing equivalent exists for ECS (from interview)
- Scattered tools were the most common group-work complaint: 8 of 10 respondents, two of whom also cited reliance on external platforms (from survey)
- Finding the group page and members works differently in every project, also raised in a second interview (Cara) (from interview)

Personality Traits:

- Adaptable: works with whatever tools the group picks rather than pushing his own
- Technically confident and self-reliant on solo work, where he can ask for help at any time
- Disorganisation frustrates him more than the workload
- Prefers to see the whole picture rather than ask each person for updates
- Tolerates mess until the deadline forces a last-minute merge

Refs:

Nielsen, J. (1994). *10 Usability Heuristics for User Interface Design.* Nielsen Norman Group.
Shneiderman, B., Plaisant, C., Cohen, M., Jacobs, S., & Elmqvist, N. (2016). *Designing the User Interface: Strategies for Effective Human-Computer Interaction*